

Pembroke Institute

Admissions Information Packet, Academic Year 2027 through 2028

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Welcome from the Head of School

Pembroke Institute is an independent day school serving students from age four through grade twelve. We are a non-sectarian, co-educational community of approximately six hundred and forty students drawn from across the greater Birmingham metropolitan area. Our mission is to graduate students of independent character, intellectual seriousness, and civic readiness, prepared to lead lives of consequence in the communities they choose to serve.

This packet is intended for prospective families considering Pembroke for the 2027 through 2028 academic year. It contains an overview of the school, our academic and co-curricular programs, the admissions process and timeline, tuition and financial aid information, and contact information for the admissions team. We encourage you to read it carefully, and we look forward to meeting you on campus during the open-house and tour cycle described in section three.

Pembroke Institute admits students of any race, color, national or ethnic origin to all the rights, privileges, programs, and activities generally accorded or made available to students at the school. We do not discriminate on the basis of race, color, national or ethnic origin, religion, sex, or any other protected characteristic in administration of our educational policies, admissions policies, financial aid programs, athletic programs, or other school-administered programs.

Section 1. The school in brief

Pembroke Institute was founded in nineteen seventy-three by a group of Birmingham educators who believed the city deserved a small, academically rigorous independent school with deep roots in the region's civic life. The school opened in temporary space in the basement of a downtown church with thirty-four students and three teachers, moved to its current campus in nineteen seventy-nine, and has grown to its present size while remaining committed to the small-school principles that animated its founders.

The campus occupies fourteen acres on the eastern edge of the Mountain Brook border, with academic buildings serving Lower School (age four through grade four), Middle School (grades five through eight), and Upper School (grades nine through twelve). The campus includes two libraries, three science laboratories, an art and design studio, a music conservatory wing, an athletic complex with two playing fields and a six-court tennis facility, a black-box theater, and a dining commons that serves all three divisions.

The student-to-faculty ratio is eight to one across all divisions. Average class size in the Upper School is twelve students. Average class size in the Middle School is fourteen. Lower School homerooms are capped at sixteen students with two teachers per homeroom.

Section 2. Academic program by division

The Lower School emphasizes foundational literacy and numeracy, with daily blocks of reading, writing, mathematics, and structured exploratory time. Specialist instruction in Spanish, music, art, physical education, and library begins in the earliest grades. Students take one full-class field trip per quarter and one extended field trip per year.

The Middle School transitions students into a departmental schedule with subject-specific teachers in English, history, mathematics, science, world language (Spanish, French, or Mandarin), arts, and physical education. Middle School students participate in a required ethics seminar in seventh and eighth grade and complete a research-based independent project in the final term of eighth grade.

The Upper School offers the standard college-preparatory curriculum, with honors and advanced sections in core subjects from ninth grade and Advanced Placement offerings in thirteen subjects across the four years. Upper School students complete four years of English, four years of mathematics including pre-calculus, three years of laboratory science, three years of history including a required year of United States history, three years of a single world language, and one full year of fine arts. Graduation requirements include a senior independent project completed in the spring term and a community service commitment of one hundred hours across the four Upper School years.

Section 3. Co-curricular program

Pembroke fields competitive teams in twelve sports across the Upper School (football, soccer, cross country, volleyball, basketball, swimming, indoor track, baseball, softball, lacrosse, tennis, golf, and outdoor track) and in eight sports across the Middle School. The school competes in the Birmingham Independent Schools Athletic Conference and at the state level in approved sports. Athletic participation is open to all students; the school does not cut students from teams below the varsity level.

The arts program includes a Middle School orchestra and chorus, an Upper School orchestra, two Upper School choral ensembles, a jazz band, a wind ensemble, three theater productions per year (fall play, winter musical, spring student-directed showcase), a visual arts studio program with concentrations in drawing, painting, ceramics, photography, and digital media, and an extended-day art studio open to all students three afternoons per week.

Student-led clubs run the standard range, including model UN, robotics, debate, literary magazine, yearbook, student government, environmental club, community service club, affinity groups across multiple identity dimensions, and a long-standing chess club that has produced state-ranked players in three of the past five years.

Section 4. Admissions process and timeline

Open-house sessions for the 2027 through 2028 academic year are scheduled for Sunday, October 11, 2026 (Lower and Middle School), Sunday, October 25, 2026 (Upper School), and Sunday, November 8, 2026 (all divisions, returning families and late applicants). Tours of campus are available by appointment Monday through Friday at nine, ten thirty, and one in the afternoon, and on the first and third Saturdays of each month at ten in the morning. Tours are scheduled through the admissions office.

Application deadline for the 2027 through 2028 academic year is December 15, 2026. Required application materials include the completed application form, the application fee of one hundred and twenty dollars, transcripts from the current and prior two academic years, two teacher recommendations, a student essay, a parent statement, and standardized testing as appropriate for the entering grade.

Admissions decisions are released on March 8, 2027. Families have until March 29, 2027 to accept the offered place and submit the enrollment contract and the deposit.

Section 5. Tuition and fees, 2027 through 2028 academic year

Division	Grade	Annual Tuition	Books and Fees	Lunch Plan	Total per Year
Lower School	PreK and K	\$13,400	\$650	\$1,050	\$15,100
Lower School	Grades 1 to 2	\$13,950	\$650	\$1,050	\$15,650
Lower School	Grades 3 to 4	\$14,200	\$700	\$1,050	\$15,950
Middle School	Grades 5 to 6	\$14,200	\$800	\$1,200	\$16,200
Middle School	Grades 7 to 8	\$14,200	\$850	\$1,200	\$16,250
Upper School	Grades 9 to 10	\$15,400	\$950	\$1,400	\$17,750
Upper School	Grades 11 to 12	\$15,400	\$1,100	\$1,400	\$17,900

Tuition is payable in two installments (July and December) or in ten installments (July through April) through the school's tuition management partner. A one-time enrollment fee of seven hundred and fifty dollars is required at the time of enrollment for new families. The enrollment fee is not refundable after April 1.

Additional optional costs include after-school care (Lower School only, fifteen dollars per afternoon, monthly billing), Saturday enrichment programs (per-program fee), athletic team participation fees (between one hundred and three hundred dollars per sport per season), and overnight class trips (Middle School and Upper School, between two hundred and one thousand two hundred dollars per trip).

Section 6. Financial aid program

Pembroke is committed to enrolling academically qualified students regardless of family financial circumstance. Approximately twenty-eight percent of Pembroke students currently receive need-based financial aid. The average aid award for the 2026 through 2027 academic year is approximately fifty-two percent of tuition, with awards ranging from partial assistance through full tuition coverage for families demonstrating substantial need.

Financial aid applications are processed through School and Student Services, an independent national organization that performs the underlying need analysis. Families seeking financial aid should submit the SSS Parents' Financial Statement and required tax documentation by the financial aid deadline of December 15, 2026, which coincides with the application deadline. Financial aid decisions are released with admissions decisions on March 8, 2027.

Section 7. Standardized testing requirements by entering grade

Entering Grade	Required Testing	Test Window
PreK and K	School-administered readiness screening	December 2026 through February 2027
Grades 1 to 4	WPPSI or WISC, age-appropriate	November 2026 through February 2027
Grades 5 to 8	ISEE Middle Level	November 2026 through February 2027
Grades 9 to 10	SSAT or ISEE Upper Level	November 2026 through February 2027
Grades 11 to 12	SAT or ACT, with school transcript	Most recent available

Pembroke does not require interviews for entering grades below grade five. For grades five and above, a student interview is part of the admissions process and is scheduled at the time the application is received. Family interviews are optional but encouraged for all entering grades and are routinely scheduled together with campus tours.

Section 8. College placement and post-secondary outcomes

Pembroke graduates pursue a wide range of post-secondary paths. Approximately ninety-six percent of recent graduates have matriculated to four-year colleges and universities. Eighty-five percent have been accepted to at least one of their top three institutional choices. Recent graduates have matriculated to Harvard, Yale, Princeton, Stanford, MIT, Duke, Vanderbilt, Emory, Rice, Tulane, the University of North Carolina, Davidson, the University of the South, Spelman, Morehouse, Howard, the University of Alabama, Auburn, Birmingham-Southern, and a range of other strong colleges and universities across the country.

The Upper School college counseling program begins formally in the spring of tenth grade with a family planning meeting and continues through senior year with individual student counseling, college visits, application support, and financial aid guidance. The student-to-counselor ratio in the college counseling office is forty to one, well below the national average for independent schools.

Section 9. School calendar overview, 2027 through 2028

First day of school for returning students: Wednesday, August 18, 2027. First day for new students: Tuesday, August 17, 2027 (orientation day). Labor Day holiday: Monday, September 6. Fall parent conferences: week of October 11. Fall break: Thursday October 21 and Friday October 22 paired with the weekend. Veterans Day holiday: Thursday, November 11. Thanksgiving recess: Wednesday November 24 through Friday November 26. Winter recess: Monday December 20, 2027 through Friday January 7, 2028. Spring parent conferences: week of February 21. Spring break: Monday March 13 through Friday March 17. Easter weekend, no classes Good Friday April 14. Last day of classes for graduating seniors: Friday May 19, 2028. Commencement: Saturday May 27, 2028. Last day for all other students: Wednesday June 7, 2028.

Section 10. Admissions team and contact information

Madeline Trent serves as Director of Admissions. She is the primary contact for prospective families and is reachable at (205) 555-0431 or mtrent@pembrokeinstitute.org. The admissions office is open Monday through Friday from eight in the morning until five in the afternoon. Tour and interview scheduling is handled through the admissions office front desk at (205) 555-0432.

Roland Hadley, Assistant Director of Admissions, oversees Middle School and Upper School recruiting and outreach. He is reachable at rhadley@pembrokeinstitute.org. Lauren Whitestone, Admissions Associate, handles Lower School inquiries and is reachable at lwhitestone@pembrokeinstitute.org.

Section 11. Visiting the school during the application cycle

We strongly encourage every prospective family to visit campus at least twice during the application cycle. The first visit might be an open-house session, which gives families a sense of the full school community and the chance to meet division heads, faculty, and current parents in a structured group setting. The second visit might be a private tour and family interview, which gives families a quieter, more focused look at the division most relevant to their student and the chance to ask specific questions of the admissions team.

Students applying to the Middle School or Upper School are encouraged to spend a partial shadow day on campus during the application cycle, attending classes with a current student host and joining the student lunch. Shadow days are scheduled through the admissions office and are available on most school days from late October through early February.